democratic values. It is almost certain, for example, that if the conflict were to be resolved, the Israeli GNP would double, every citizen's sense of well-being would completely change, and Israel would become a country no less wealthy than Switzerland or the Netherlands. It is therefore clear that if relinquishing territories can bring an end to the conflict this concession must be made. Despite all the pain involved, giving up land in exchange for an end to the conflict is a worthwhile goal. And from a different, moral, angle, there is no doubt that human life is worth more than a piece of land. This is all the more true since over time, from the Biltmore conference and onwards, the territory of the State of Israel has continued to expend.

However, because I think Israel will not accept legal Palestinian sovereignty in Jerusalem, because Israel cannot absorb Palestinian refugees, and because Israel must demand that the Palestinians withdraw their demand for the "right of return," the conflict will not end in the immediate future (I said this in 2010). In the near future, the gap between Israel's existential needs and the basic demands of the Palestinians will not be bridged. Therefore, as the failures of Ehud Barak and Ehud Olmert proved, as of 2010 it seemed impossible to reach a permanent agreement. Instead, I argued, a strategy should be developed that would allow both sides to gradually reduce the areas of disagreement between them. Long-term Israeli-Palestinian coexistence that would not be based on a peace treaty needed to be fostered. Only after a decade or longer of such coexistence would there be a chance that Israelis and Palestinians would be able to deal with the fundamental issues of the conflict. At the time of this book's writing, it can be said with certainty that any new diplomatic initiative will require a window of between half a decade and a decade in order to mature into a permanent settlement. I believe that today the chaos that prevails in the Middle East can serve as a window of opportunity for the realization of a permanent agreement within the framework of a regional arrangement that will follow the era of ISIS and al-Qaeda.

Long-term Israeli-Palestinian coexistence must be based on a new balancing point between the parties. Only if such a point can be found will it be possible to shape a new diplomatic reality, not just an agreement, that will last for many years. In order to give long-term coexistence a real chance, another condition must be fulfilled—an economic "Marshall Plan" for the Palestinian Authority, to boost the Palestinian economy and standard of living. Such a program should be carried out by the Organisation for